(iv) To provide a conducive environment and facilities for research, training, and education among the members

(v) To serve as a centre of information and as an ASEAN link with other international organizations.

8.7.2 Functions of the ASEAN

(i) It facilitates free movement of goods, services and investments within ASEAN by creating a single regional market like the European Union.

(ii) It provides free access to the marketers of one member country to the markets of all other member countries, thus fostering growth in the region.

(iii) It improves business competitiveness between businesses from different countries and also narrow developmental gaps between member countries.

(iv) It paves way for market and investment opportunities for the member nations.

(v) It fosters co-operations in many areas including industry and trade.

All the ASEAN economies experienced a great economic crisis in the year 1997.

8.8 BRICS

BRICS is the acronym for an association of five major emerging national economies: **Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa**. Originally the first four were grouped as "BRIC" before the induction of South Africa in 2010. The term 'BRIC' was coined in 2001. The BRICS members are known for their significant influence on regional affairs. Since 2009, the BRICS nations have met annually at formal summits. South Africa hosted the 10th BRICS summit in July 2018. The agenda for BRICS summit 2018 includes Inclusive growth, Trade issues, Global governance, Shared Prosperity, International peace and security.



It's headquarters is at **Shanghai, China**. The New Development Bank (NDB) formerly referred to as the BRICS Development Bank was established by BRICS States. The first BRICS summit was held at Moscow and South Africa hosted the Tenth Conference at Johanesberg in July 2018. India had an opportunity of hosting fourth and Eighth summits in 2012 and 2016 respectively.

Few Facts About The BRICS

- The BRICS countries make up 21 percent of global GDP. They have increased their share of global GDP threefold in the past 15 years.
- The BRICS are home to 43 percent of the world's population.
- The BRICS countries have combined foreign reserves of an estimated $4.4 trillion